Embracing the Act

Kriti Sanon on her latest film—*Tere Ishk Mein*—and maturing as an actor

Q. Your *Tere Ishk Mein* director Aanand L. Rai says you've matured as an actor in the last five years. Do you feel more assured in your thespian skills?

Only when you try to learn from every film do you get better at your craft. I was craving to do something meaty and headline a film and nothing was coming my way. Then *Mimi* (2021) happened and the rest is history.

Q. Some criticism has come the way of *Tere Ishk Mein* for perpetuating misogyny and romanticising abuse. Your thoughts?

Polarised views and debate are great—as long as you are discussing something it means it has affected you. I like the extreme feelings the film is evoking. It has not been made to deliver a social message. For me it is a story of the extent to which one can go for love, where they almost destroy themselves, and what not giving a chance to love at the right time does to them.

Q. How important is it to your artistic process to not judge a character's intent, especially when she can be divisive?

You cannot judge. It's like in life sometimes we make mistakes or hurt people unintentionally and end up doing things that we shouldn't have, but we have reasons for why we did what we did. That's how I approached my part in the film.

Q. What can one expect from you in 2026?

I like to challenge myself every time and give my audiences a bit of *hatke* content. Shooting for *Tere Ishk Mein* was emotionally draining so I was craving something fun and light and *Cocktail 2* was a perfect film to follow it up with. I am also loving the role of being a hands-on entrepreneur with my brand Hyphen.

with Suhani Singh

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH